

ANCIENT HISTORY



MODULE - 18

GUPTA DYNASTY
PART-1

OUR APPROACH TO FIND HISTORY FROM MYSTERY?

PRE - HISTORY

The period of time before written records.

- Stone Age
- Metal Age

PROTO - HISTORY

IVC

Aryan Invasion

VEDIC AGE
(1500 – 500 B.C.)

EARLY VEDIC AGE
(1500 – 1000 B.C.)

LATER VEDIC AGE
(1000 – 500 B.C.)

RELIGION & PHILOSOPHY



JAINISM



BUDDHISM

HISTORIC PERIOD

MAHAJANAPADAS

TERRITORIAL EXPANSION

MAGADHA

NANDA DYNASTY

Alexander Invasion

MAURYAN DYNASTY

MAURYAN DYNASTY

GUPTA DYNASTY

Foreign Invasion

KUSHAN EMPIRE

SATAVAHANAS

MAUKHARIS

VAKATAKAS

KADAMBAS

SANGAM AGE

CHOLA

CHERA

PANDYA

PUSHYABHUTHI DYNASTY

Huns Invasion

CHALUKYAS

PALLAVAS



GUPTA DYNASTY

ABOUT THE DYNASTY

SOURCES

KINGS AND THEIR CONTRIBUTION

CONSOLIDATION OF EMPIRE AND TERRITORIAL EXTENT

POLITICAL STRUCTURE/ SOCIAL LIFE/ ECONOMIC DEVELOPMENT

SIGNIFICANCE OF THE DYNASTY

HOW DYNASTY DECLINED

OTHER FACTS

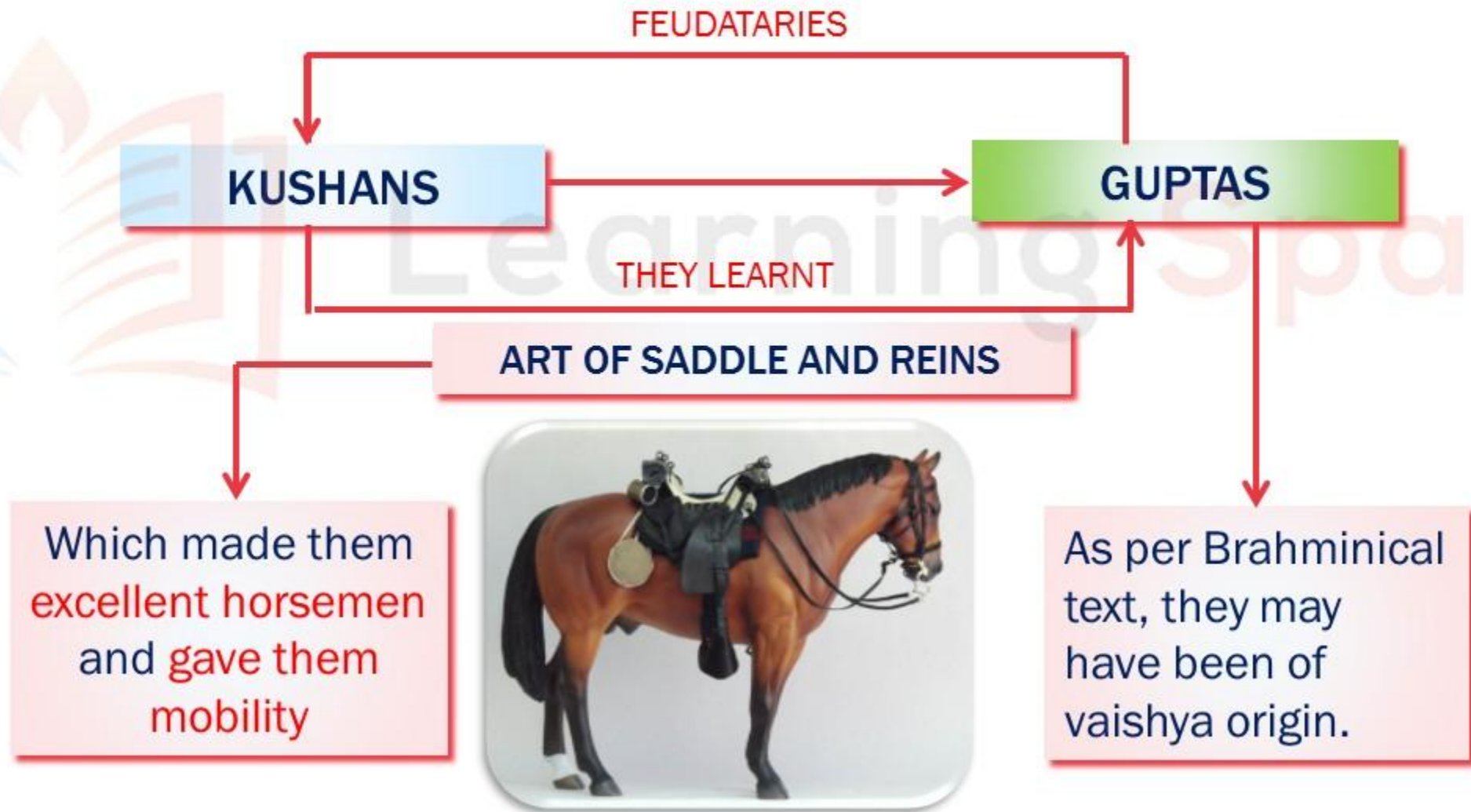
GUPTA DYNASTY



GUPTA EMPIRE

(320A.D. To 550A.D.)

WHO WERE GUPTAS?



GUPTA EMPIRE

(320A.D. To 550A.D.)

FAVOURABLE CONDITIONS FOR THE RISE OF GUPTA

4 Their **center of operation** lying in the **fertile land** of Madhya desh covering Bihar and UP.



3 The **presence of iron ore** of central India and south Bihar.



1 Due to **proximity to the areas of northern India** they were involved in **prosperous silk trade**.



2 They skilfully used combination of policy like **war, diplomacy and matrimonial alliances** to consolidate the power.

Gupta seem to have succeeded after Kushan without any time-lag i.e evident by presence of Kushan antiquities immediately followed by Guptas antiquities.

ABOUT THE DYNASTY

SOURCES

KINGS AND THEIR CONTRIBUTION

CONSOLIDATION OF EMPIRE AND TERRITORIAL EXTENT

POLITICAL STRUCTURE/ SOCIAL LIFE/ ECONOMIC DEVELOPMENT

SIGNIFICANCE OF THE DYNASTY

HOW DYNASTY DECLINED

OTHER FACTS

THE SOURCES OF GUPTA DYNASTY

ARCHAEOLOGICAL

LITERARY

RELIGIOUS

- Puranas
- Dharmashastras

SECULAR

TRAVELLER'S MEMORIES

CHINESE TRAVELLER-
FAHEIN

PLAYS / DRAMAS / POEMS

Visakadatta's

- **Mudrarakshasa**
- **Devichandraguptam**-
it tells us about
Ramagupta's defeat
by Shaka king.

COINS (Numismatics)



MONUMENTS STUPAS, VIHARAS



ARTIFACTS & OBJECTS



INSCRIPTIONS AND EDICTS

ALLAHABAD
AND MEHRAULI
INSCRIPTION

OTHERS



GUPTA EMPIRE

(320A.D. To 550A.D.)

SAMUDRAGUPTA I

(330A.D. To 380A.D.)



ALLAHABAD PILLAR INSCRIPTION

Harisena the court poet of Samudragupta composed these inscription called "**Prayag prasasti**".

← INSCRIPTIONS →



MEHRAULI PILLAR INSCRIPTION

Mehrauli iron pillar inscription fixed near Qutub Minar in Delhi mention about Chandragupta II.

ABOUT THE DYNASTY

SOURCES

KINGS AND THEIR CONTRIBUTION

CONSOLIDATION OF EMPIRE AND TERRITORIAL EXTENT

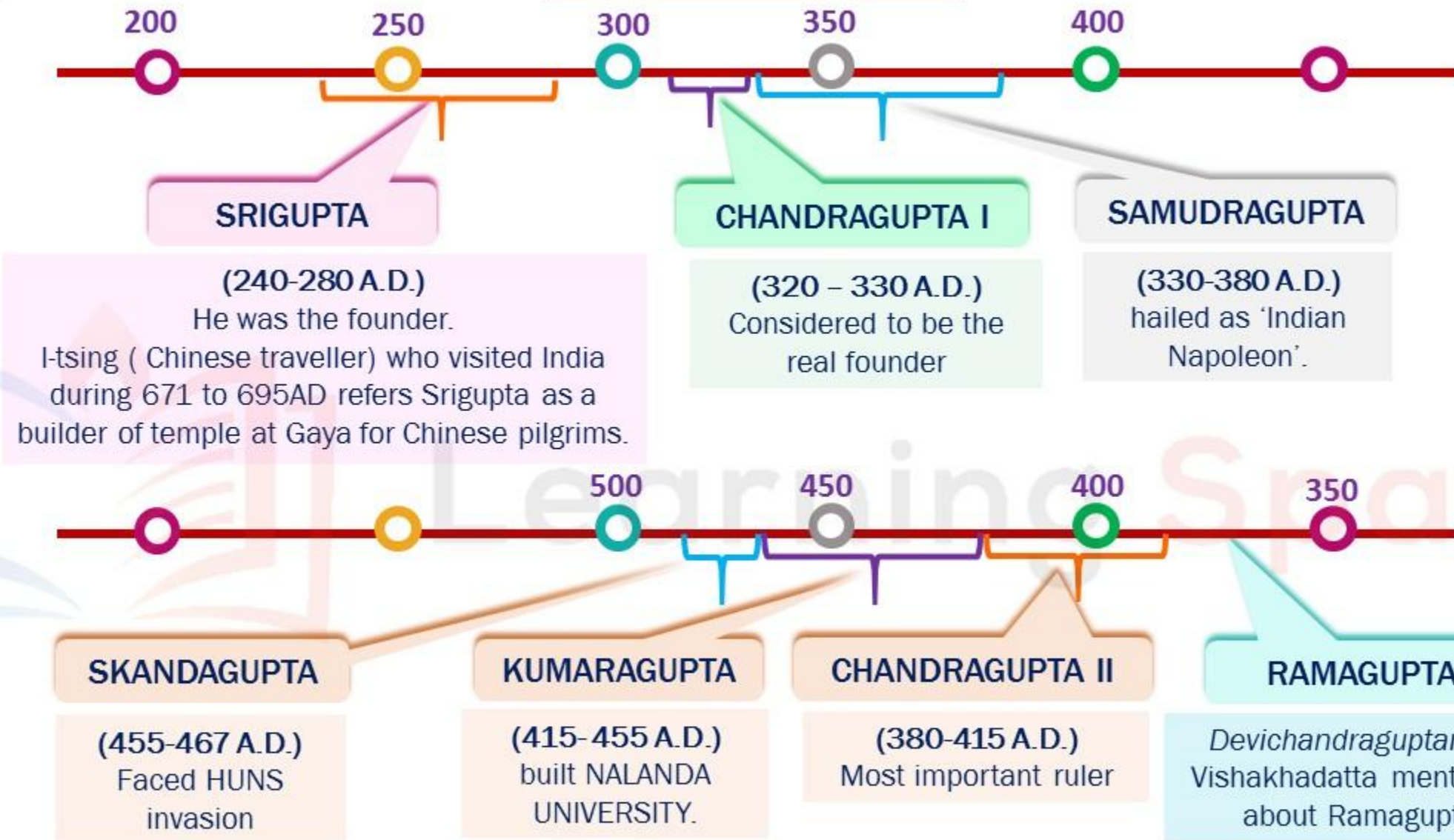
POLITICAL STRUCTURE/ SOCIAL LIFE/ ECONOMIC DEVELOPMENT

SIGNIFICANCE OF THE DYNASTY

HOW DYNASTY DECLINED

OTHER FACTS

GUPTA DYNASTY



After Skandagupta's death, many of his successors like Purugupta, Narasimhagupta, Buddhagupta and Baladitya came to the throne.

GUPTA EMPIRE

(320A.D. To 550A.D.)

CHANDRAGUPTA I

(320A.D. To 330 A.D.)



- 1 He called himself as **MAHARAJADHIRAJ** (the greatest of then king). He is known to have turned small ancestral kingdom to an empire.

- 2 **Matrimonial alliance** of Chandragupta and Lichhavi princess (NEPAL)- helped him to expand his political power.

- **Guptas were probably Vaishyas**, hence marriage in Kshatriya family gave them prestige.

- 3 He started the GUPTA ERA (319-320 AD) to mark the date of his accession.

GUPTA EMPIRE

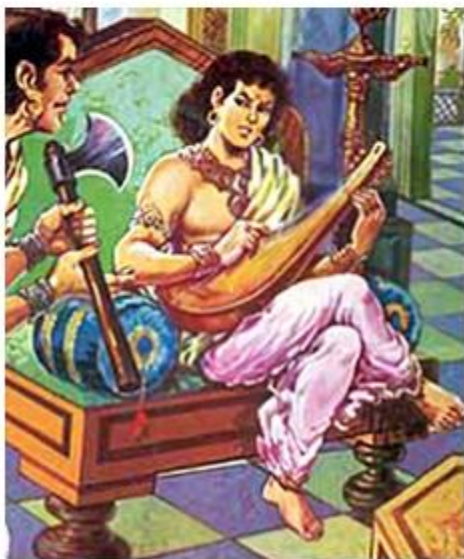
(320A.D. To 550A.D.)

SAMUDRAGUPTA I

(330A.D. To 380A.D.)

1

- He was called as '**Napoleon of India**' by Vincent Smith.
- He was the greatest of the rulers of the Gupta dynasty.
- He enormously expanded the empire.



His image depicting him with Veena is found in the coins issued by him. It is the proof of his proficiency and interest in music.

2

RELIGION

- He was an **ardent follower of Vaishnavism** but he was **tolerant** towards other religion.
- He has interest in Buddhism and was the patron of the great **Buddhist scholar Vasubandu**.

3

He is also known for **promoting Sanskrit** literature and learning.

4

Court poet of Samudragupta Harisena describes him as **hero of 100 battles**

GUPTA EMPIRE

(320A.D. To 550A.D.)

SAMUDRAGUPTA I

(330A.D. To 380A.D.)

HOW SAMUDRAGUPTA EXPANDED HIS EMPIRE?

SOUTHERN POLICY (DAKSHINVARTHA)

- He adopted different policy in South India.
- He **did not destroy and annex the kingdoms.**
- Instead, he defeated the rulers but **gave them back their kingdoms.**
- He only insisted on them to acknowledge his suzerainty.

NORTHERN POLICY (ARYAVRATA)

According to this policy **he defeated and exterminated the king.**



OTHER POLICIES INCULDE

- TRIBAL POLICY
- BORDER AREA POLICY
- ISLAND POLICY

Military achievements of Samudragupta were recorded in "ALLAHABAD PILLAR INSCRIPTION".

GUPTA EMPIRE

(320A.D. To 550A.D.)

SAMUDRAGUPTA I

(330A.D. To 380A.D.)

INSIGHTS INTO THE MILITARY POLICY

The Allahabad Pillar inscription contains a long list of states, kings and tribes which were conquered and brought under *various degrees of subjugation*. This list can be divided into four categories.

The first one includes, the 12 states of **Dakshinapaths**, who were captured and then liberated and reinstated

The second one contains, the names of the eight kings of **Aryavarta** who were exterminated.



The third one consists of the rulers of:

- **forest states** → who were **reduced to servitude**
- **border states and tribal republics** → were forced to pay all kinds of taxes, obey his orders and come to perform obeisance.

The fourth one includes **Daivaputra Kushanas** and other island states who offered their own **person for service** to Samudragupta.

GUPTA EMPIRE

(320A.D. To 550A.D.)

SAMUDRAGUPTA I

(330A.D. To 380A.D.)

ALLAHABAD PILLAR INSCRIPTION

Speaks of Samudragupta his magnanimity to his foes, his polished intellect, his poetic skill and his proficiency in music.

Significance is that, the same pillar on which Ashoka's peace loving inscription were engraved, Samudragupta's expeditious military achievements were engraved.



Harisena the court poet of Samudragupta composed these inscription called "*prayag prasasti*" (33 lines)

It calls Samudragupta as Kaviraja because of his ability in composing verses.

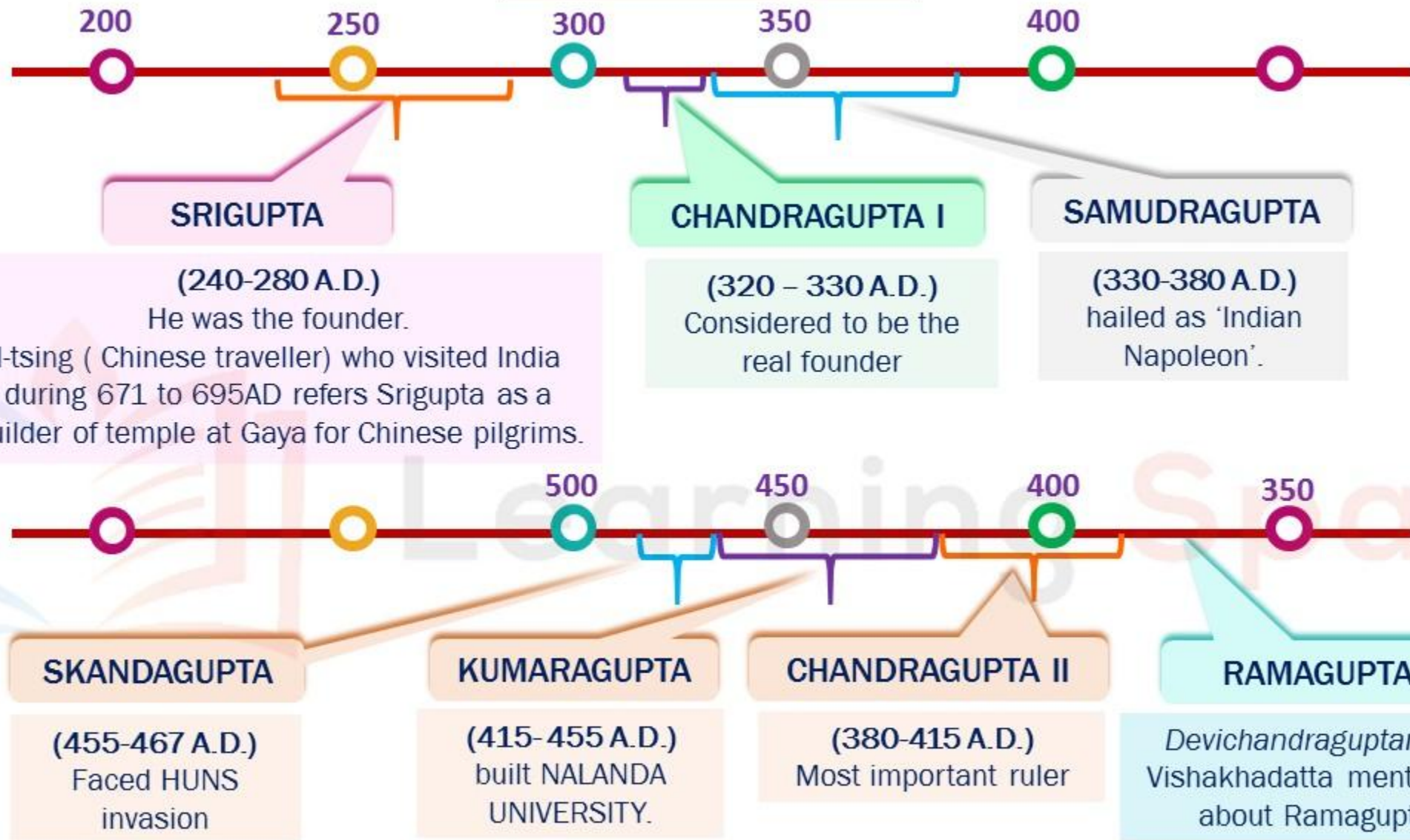
The Allahabad Pillar inscription contains a long list of states, kings and tribes which were conquered and brought under various degrees of subjugation

Inscription is written in classical Sanskrit, using the Nagari script.

SOUTHERN CAMPAIGN OF SAMUDRAGUPTA



GUPTA DYNASTY



After Skandagupta's death, many of his successors like Purugupta, Narasimhagupta, Buddhagupta and Baladitya came to the throne.

GUPTA EMPIRE

(320A.D. To 550A.D.)

CHANDRAGUPTA II- HOW HE CAME TO POWER?

(380 A.D-415 A.D.)

1

Vishakhadatta in his play **Devichandraguptam** mention how King **Ramagupta** was cheated into signing a humiliating treaty with a Saka ruler.



7

Ujjain became an important commercial city and soon became the alternative capital of the Guptas.

2

Under the treaty, Ramagupta is supposed to send his wife **Dhruvadevi** to the Saka king.



6

After this victory Chandragupta performed the horse sacrifice and assumed the title "**SAKARI**", and brought Ujjain under his control.

3

Ramagupta's younger brother, **Chandragupta-II**, the protagonist of the story, takes upon himself to **avenge this humiliation**.

4

In disguise of queen, he entered enemy's camp and killed that Saka chieftain.

5

Chandragupta-II later kills Ramagupta, takes charge of the Gupta empire and also marries Dhruvadevi. This drama portraits Ramagupta as a coward and impotent person.

GUPTA EMPIRE

(320A.D. To 550A.D.)

CHANDRAGUPTA II

(380 A.D-415 A.D.)

WHY CHANDRAGUPTA II ASSUMED THE TITLE “SHAKARI” OR “VIKRAMADITYA” ?



- 1 ■ Back in the history , around 1st C BC, there was ruler of Ujjain, VIKRAMADITYA who was strong and successful in containing Shaka ruler and assumed himself title “SHAKARI” (Enemy of Shakas).
■ He also started Vikram Samvat ERA (57BC).
- 2 ■ Later Chandragupta II , around 4th C AD after defeating Shakas assumed the same title “VIKRAMADITYA”.

GUPTA EMPIRE

(320A.D. To 550A.D.)

CHANDRAGUPTA II- HOW HE CAME TO POWER?

(380 A.D-415 A.D.)

HOW CHANDRAGUPTA II EXAPNDED HIS EMPIRE?



1

Matrimonial alliance

1. He himself married Kuberanaga, Naga princess of **central india**.
2. His gave his daughter Prabhavati to Vakataka prince. Later due to premature death of prince the administration was overseen by Prabhavati. The political importance of this marriage was-
 - Vakatakas occupied **a geographically strategic position** in the Deccan which gave Gupta **indirect control to Deccan region**
 - This alliance served useful when Chandragupta-II campaigned against Sakas. This victory gave kingdom **access to western seas**.

GUPTA EMPIRE

(320A.D. To 550A.D.)

CHANDRAGUPTA II

(380 A.D-415 A.D.)

HOW CHANDRAGUPTA II EXAPNDED HIS EMPIRE?



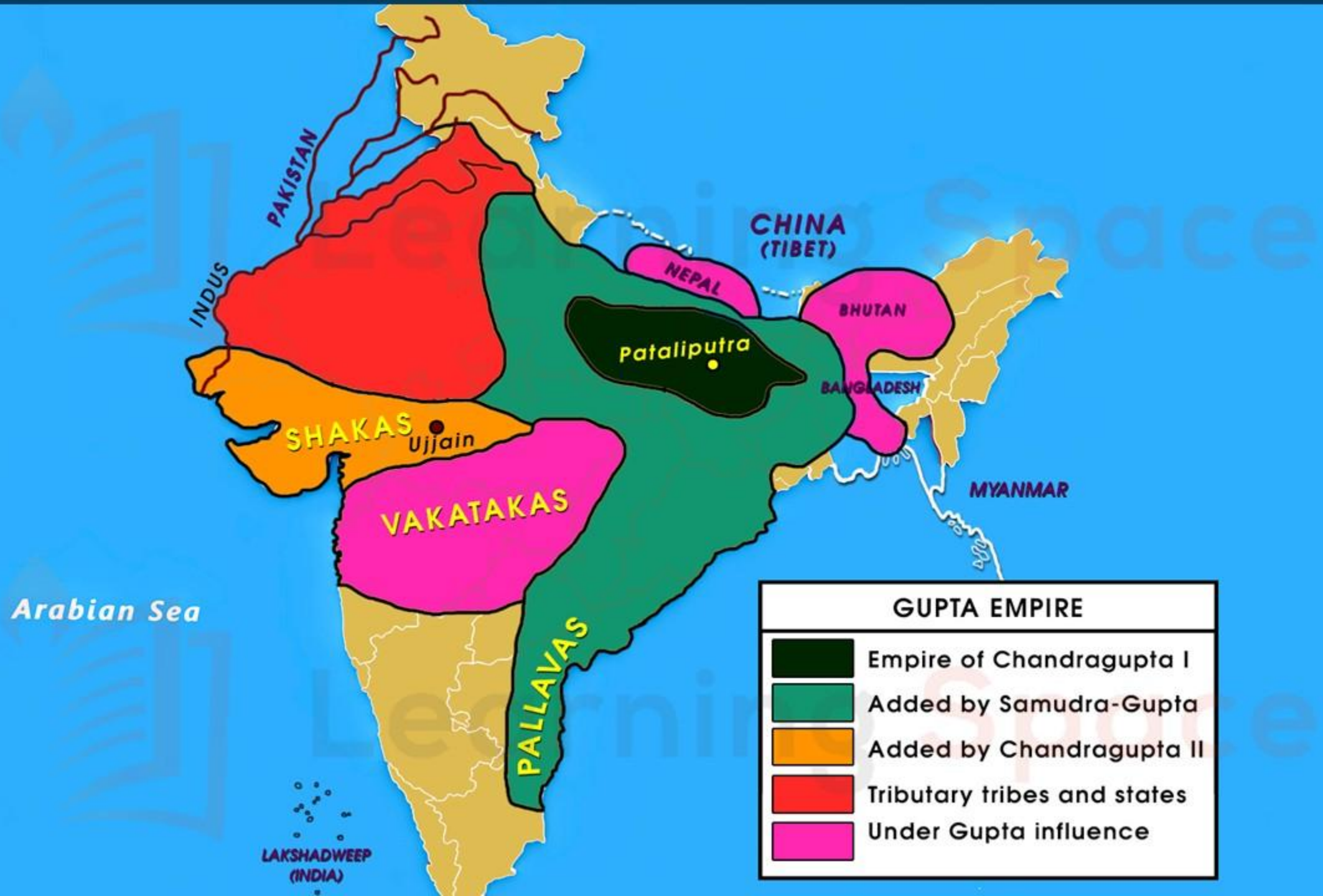
Chandragupta II empire

- In the west extends up to the Broach, Sopara and Cambay and other seaports which enabled to control trade with west
- In the east include eastern Bengal and
- In the south the Narmada river formed the boundary.

2

Conquest by war

- In the **northwest** → crossed the river Sindh and conquered some areas of Bactria and the Kushanas. So kingdom **extended beyond the Hindukush** up to Bactria.
- In the **west** → western Malwa, Gujarat and Kathiawar.
- He defeated a confederacy of enemy chiefs in **Vanga/banga**.



GUPTA EMPIRE	
	Empire of Chandragupta I
	Added by Samudra-Gupta
	Added by Chandragupta II
	Tributary tribes and states
	Under Gupta influence

GUPTA EMPIRE

(320A.D. To 550A.D.)

CHANDRAGUPTA II (380-415 A.D.)

FAHIEN VISIT

Came to India by the land route. The main purpose of his visit was to **see the land of the Buddha** and to **collect Buddhist manuscripts** from India.

He provides **valuable information** on the religious, social and economic condition of the **Gupta empire**. But did not mention the name of Chandragupta II



According to him, Buddhism was in a **flourishing** condition in the **north western** India but in the **Gangetic valley** it was in a state of neglect. He refers to the Gangetic valley as the '**LAND OF BRAHMINISM**'.

Fahien mentions the **unsatisfactory state** of some of the **Buddhist holy places** like Kapilavastu and Kusinagara.

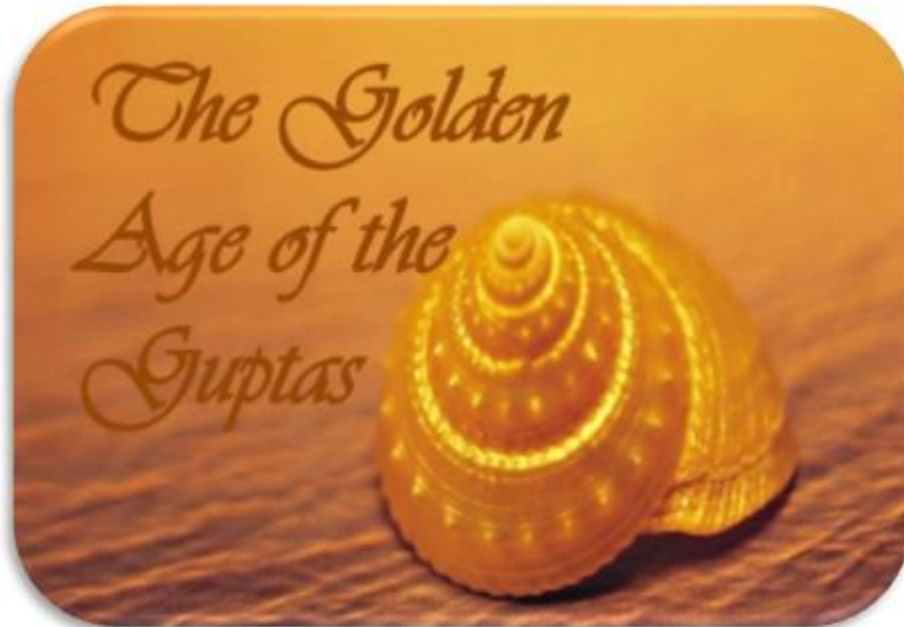
He was not interested in political affairs. His interest was primarily religion.

GUPTA EMPIRE

(320A.D. To 550A.D.)

CHANDRAGUPTA II (380-415 A.D.)

CULTURAL PROGRESS



- 1 The power and glory of Gupta empire **reached its peak** under the rule of Chandragupta II Vikramaditya.
- 2 He promoted **artistic activity** and patronized great literary figures like Kalidasa, Dhanvantri etc.
- 3 His court was adorned by **9 gems or 9 jewels**.

Because of the high level of cultural progress that was achieved during this period, the Gupta period is generally referred to as a "GOLDEN AGE". It is the period of great cultural prosperity and flourishing of art and culture.

GUPTA EMPIRE (320A.D. To 550A.D.)

CHANDRAGUPTA II (380-415 A.D.)

NINE GEMS OR NAVRATANAS

2

GHATAKARPURA-
SCULPTURE AND
ARCHITECTURE

8

DHANVANTARI-
PHYSICIAN

6

VARARUCHI-
GRAMMARIAN
AND SANSKRIT
SCHOLAR

1

SHANKU-
ARCHITECT

5

AMARASIMHA-
SANSKRIT
LEXICOGRAPHER

3

VARAHAMIHIRA-
MATHEMATICIAN
AND ASTROLOGER

4

KSHAPANAK-
ASTROLOGER

9

VETALA BHATTA-
MAGICIAN

7

KALIDASA-
SANSKRIT POET
, PLAYWRITER

GUPTA EMPIRE

(320A.D. To 550A.D.)

KUMARAGUPTA



He laid the foundation of the **Nalanda University** which emerged as an **institution of international reputation**

- 1** Kumaragupta was the son and successor of Chandragupta II.
- 2** His reign was marked by **general peace and prosperity**. A large number of coins and inscription were found all over empire during his period.
- 3** **No major military conquest** in his period.
- 4** At the near end of his reign, a powerful wealthy tribe of **central India**, living on the banks of Narmada river called the 'Pushyamitras' **defeated the Gupta army**.

GUPTA EMPIRE

(320A.D. To 550A.D.)

SKANDAGUPTA



Skandagupta, known for renovating **SUDARSHAN LAKE**, as mentioned in JUNAGARH INSCRIPTION.

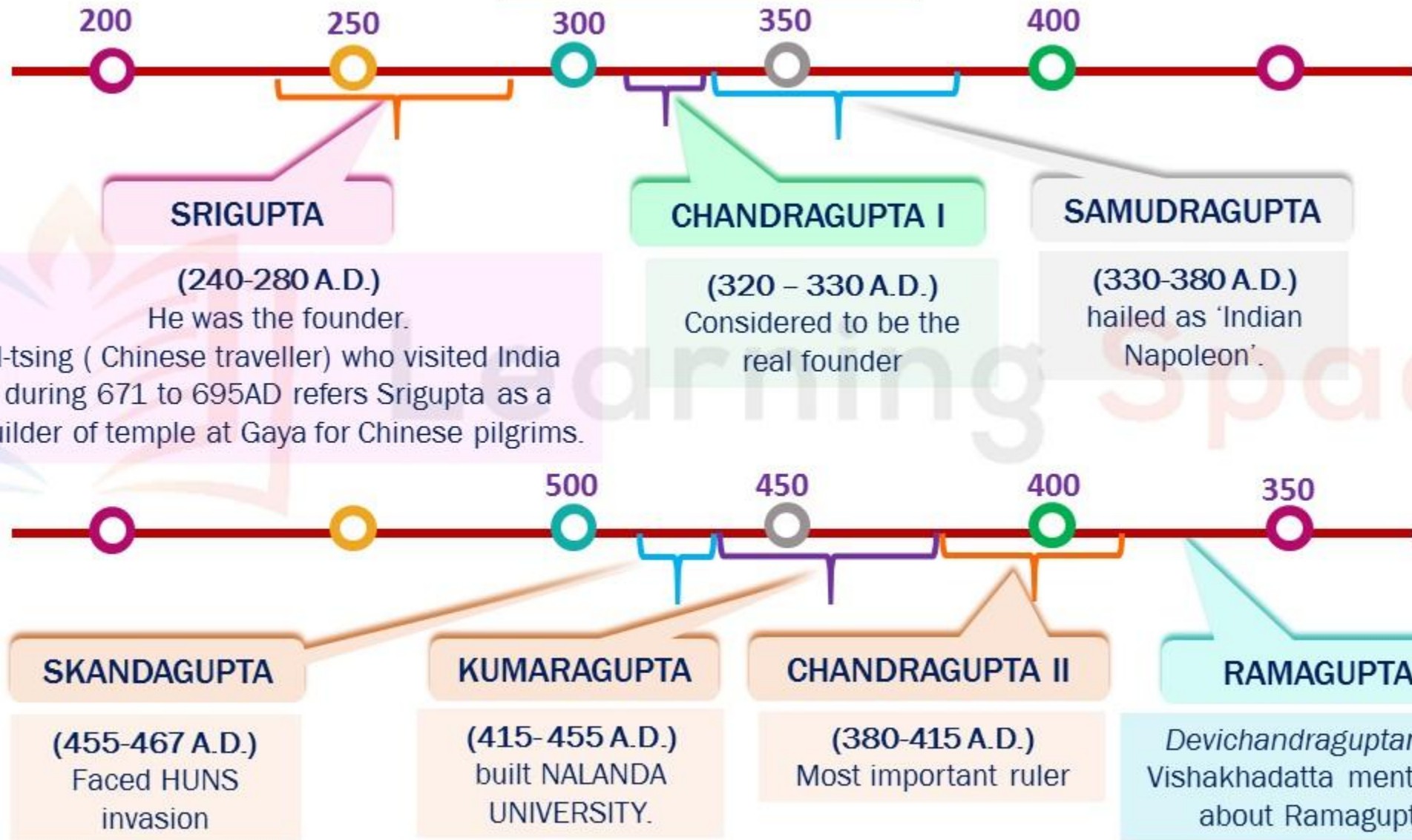
The war with Huns must have been a great strain on the government's resources. After Skandagupta's death, many of his successors **could not save the Gupta empire from the Huns.**

1 Successor of Kumargupta, Skandagupta neither had complete control of his empire nor had full support of his people. These were early signs of fall of Gupta empire.

2 He **checked Huns invasion**. However he **could not completely crush the rebellion** who rose again after his death

3 He is also credited with defeating "**Pushyamitras**" who defeated gupta army during Kumaragupta period.

GUPTA DYNASTY



After Skandagupta's death, many of his successors like Purugupta, Narasimhagupta, Buddhagupta and Baladitya came to the throne.

Q & A

Q.1 Match the following:

(A) Dhanvantri

(B) Shanku

(C) Charaka

(D) Vetāla Bhaṭṭa

(i) Physician

(ii) Architect

(iii) Astronomy

(iv) Magician

a) A - i, B - iii, C - iv, D - ii

b) A - i, B - ii, C - iii, D - iv

c) A - ii, B - iii, C - i, D - iv

d) A - iii, B - iv, C - i, D - ii

ANSWER b)

Q & A

Q.1 Nalanda University, the most famous Ancient Educational Institution which was Internationally acclaimed was founded during reign of:-

- a) Kumaragupta
- b) Skandagupta
- c) Ramagupta
- d) Kanishka I

ANSWER a)

Q & A

Q.2 The Allahabad Pillar inscription is associated with which one of the following?

- a) Mahapadma Nanda
- b) Chandragupta Maurya
- c) Ashoka
- d) Samudragupta

ANSWER d)

ABOUT THE DYNASTY

SOURCES

KINGS AND THEIR CONTRIBUTION

CONSOLIDATION OF EMPIRE AND TERRITORIAL EXTENT

POLITICAL STRUCTURE/ SOCIAL LIFE/ ECONOMIC DEVELOPMENT

SIGNIFICANCE OF THE DYNASTY

HOW DYNASTY DECLINED

OTHER FACTS

WE EXPRESS OUR SINCERE THANKS FOR VIEWING THIS VIDEO

Presented by



Learning Space

For Suggestions:

suggestions@learningspace.in

To Contact us:

info@learningspace.in

OUR TEAM

G. V. Rao

L. V. Krishna

Y. Deepthi

Y. Prema Manvi

S. Manoj Kumar

Mayank Chaudhary

D. Shruti Reddy

G. Ravi Babu

K. Victor Babu

D. Joji

Visit us at:

www.learningspacedigital.com

0 8 6 6 -2 4 4 4 4 7 2

0 9 8 4 9 9 4 2 2 9 9